

HUSBANDS AND WIVES

†1. **Ted L. Gibbons:** “We must not neglect to see the following message in these verses: *the wife’s support of her husband is her responsibility and affair; not her husband’s. This is a covenant relationship and only works in an environment of agency and love.*

You cannot imagine the Father yelling at the Son and *demanding* obedience and respect because he is, after all, the Father. You cannot believe that the Father would belittle or ridicule the Son over some small mistake. “*That is a terrible place for a forest!*” The power of this holy relationship is found in the fact that the Son chooses to respect and obey his Father because of his absolute trust in his Father’s righteousness. And it must be on this basis alone that the wife submits to the husband. Thus we see again that ‘no power or influence can or ought to be maintained by virtue of the priesthood ...’ (D&C 121:41) (New Testament Lesson 34: “[Keep the Ordinances as I Delivered Them](#),” at LDS Living; accessed 9/7/15.

†2. **President Spencer W. Kimball:** “While marriage is difficult, and discordant and frustrated marriages are common, yet real, lasting happiness is possible, and marriage can be, more an exultant ecstasy than the human mind can conceive. This is within the reach of every couple, every person. ‘Soul mates’ are a fiction and an illusion; and while every young man and young woman will seek with all diligence and prayerfulness to find a mate with whom life can be most compatible and beautiful, yet it is certain that almost any good man and any good woman can have happiness and a successful marriage if both are willing to pay the price.” (“[Oneness in Marriage](#),” *Ensign*, March 1977. See also “[Marriage and Divorce](#),” *Speeches*, 7 September 1976.)

†3. **President James E. Faust:** “Marriage is the way provided by God for the fulfillment of the greatest of human needs, based upon mutual respect, maturity, selflessness, decency, commitment, and honesty. Happiness in marriage and parenthood can exceed a thousand times any other happiness.” (“[The Enriching of Marriage](#),” *Ensign*, Nov. 1977, 11)

SACRAMENT

†4. **Self-Examination, Self-Confrontation:** “[First is Self-confrontation](#). This involves recognizing that a sin has been committed and that repentance is needed. Also, experiencing sorrow or remorse, making confession, and

suffering the consequences of having broken the moral law are involved.

...
“[Self-confrontation](#) seems difficult for many of us. It requires understanding how we avoid the truth about ourselves and what is needed to overcome that avoidance. It is said that we must recognize our errors, feel remorse or sorrow, and make confession; but this creates an immediate threat to our self-image—and by nature we tend to protect ourselves from full disclosure of our faults or, when exposed, to justify or rationalize our misconduct.

“Evidences of the fears and conflicts that are provoked by [self-confrontation](#) arose in a study of sixty BYU students that some of my colleagues and I did with support from the BYU Counseling Center and the BYU Comprehensive Clinic. We found it encouraging that a majority of the students reported abiding by the standards of the gospel. On the other hand, we found among those who had deviated that many avoided the repentance process as outlined in the scriptures and the writings of the General Authorities.

“Their ways of handling deviations were diverse, such as simply waiting until their feelings of guilt subsided; attempting to convince themselves that what they had done was really not that bad; doing something righteous to balance their account; promising themselves (and God) that they would avoid it the next time; punishing themselves by calling themselves worthless and feeling bad for one or two days; trying not to think about it; and avoiding spiritual contexts because they felt unclean.

“These practices represent defense mechanisms (denial, suppression, and rationalization)—their purpose is to defend self-esteem. The students had defined themselves as righteous, and evidence to the contrary threatened their self-images. To follow the practice of confession and repentance would have required them to acknowledge their unrighteous actions. This reflects the problem of emphasizing an external image so much that honest self self-disclosure is avoided (see page 97 of Bergin, A. E., Stinchfield, R. d., Gaskin, T. A., Masters, K. S., Sullivan, C. E., “Religious Lifestyles and Mental Health: An Exploratory Study,” *Journal of Counseling Psychology* 35 [1988] : 91-98).

“It is ironic that we fear disclosing to him who already knows what we have done. We perhaps punish ourselves more by withholding than the Lord would ever do.”

...
“Consider the person who has betrayed the trust of the Lord and of his girlfriend by pressing for and getting physical pleasure. He is a returned missionary who has been endowed in the temple and made solemn covenants regarding virtue. He is devastated but cannot face reality. He makes excuses. He hides his sin and may even

prepare or go through a temple marriage without disclosure. What can be done for people who are afraid, who fear punishment, who worry about rejection by family, or social slights, or Church discipline, and may be accustomed to being honored and admired?

“Where would such a person get the extra motivation needed to face the pain of accurate self-assessment? Numerous things can help, but there are three fundamental keys to change: faith in the Lord, the courage to act, and a feeling of being loved. Even if discipline or rebuke is involved, it is never optimal unless the person being disciplined feels loved by the one disciplining.

“It is crucial when we are into self-confrontation that our courage be encouraged. We need someone we can cry out to in pain, remorse, and full emotional expression. But such exposure of the tender and vulnerable aspects of ourselves does not usually occur unless trust exists. The sinner needs the confidence of knowing that the listener is not there to hurt but to hear, to understand, to console, and to resonate to our sense of guilt and despair.” (Alan E. Bergin, Ph.D Clinical Psychology, “[Psychology and Religion](#),” BYU Speeches, Oct. 04, 1994.)

SPIRITUAL GIFTS

†5. **Lane Johnson:** “The scriptures list many of the spiritual gifts available to man. (See [1 Cor. 12:4–11](#); [Moro. 10:9–17](#); [D&C 46:11–26](#).) Some of these, such as the gifts of prophecy or healing or the gift of tongues, are very clearly manifest when given. Others may take the more subtle form of a talent or special skill or ability to discern. For example, in the construction of the tabernacle of the congregation in the days of Moses, Bezaleel the son of Uri was given, through the Spirit, the gift of fine workmanship in metals and wood and stone. ([Ex. 31:1–5](#).) King Solomon was granted Wisdom and understanding according to his righteous desire. ([1 Kgs. 3:5–15](#).) Enoch, who was “but a lad, and ... slow of speech” ([Moses 6:31](#)) when called to declare repentance to the people of his day, received the Spirit and was thereafter able to preach mightily and to see things not visible to the natural eye.” (“[How to Receive Spiritual Gifts](#),” *Ensign*, Dec. 1975)

†6. **Elder Joseph Wirthlin’s story of Elder Shaw and Mabiglia:** “Elder Shaw had been in the mission field only two weeks when his senior companion became ill. The elders, as a consequence, had to remain in their apartment all day. Elder Shaw was moved by the Spirit and had a great desire to talk to someone about the gospel, so he picked up the phone book in which more than three million names were listed. He chose three. There was no response to the first call. To the second, a

woman answered and informed Elder Shaw that she wasn’t at all interested, and to make matters worse, declared that she couldn’t understand his poor Italian and atrocious mode of speech. On the third try, a man answered. Elder Shaw introduced himself and received a warm response. The man said his name was Mabiglia and that he would gladly receive the elders. This he did. The appointment, made so miraculously, turned into a spiritually uplifting and inspiring occasion. After the first lesson, Mr. Mabiglia said, “How wonderful! I’ve worked for two years in a bank located on the street where the missionaries have done street-board tracting. Again and again I have practically brushed them as I passed them on the street, but I was too shy to respond to them. Now, in this miraculous way, I have met you.” At this point we should change the “Mister” to “Brother,” for after receiving the lessons, the man contacted by telephone was baptized, and Brother Mabiglia is now serving in the presidency of the Naples Branch. (Elder Joseph B. Wirthlin, “[The Language of the Spirit](#),” *Ensign*, November 1975)

†7. **Elder Dallin H. Oaks:** “The relationship between these gifts illustrates the purpose for which all spiritual gifts are given: “And all these gifts come from God, for the benefit of the children of God.” ...

“We must take care never to misuse spiritual gifts. As the Prophet Joseph Smith taught, when spiritual gifts “are applied to that which God does not intend, they prove an injury, a snare and a curse instead of a blessing.” (*Teachings*, p. 248.) (“[Spiritual Gifts](#),” *Ensign*, 1986)

†8. **Elder Dallin H. Oaks:** “I saw that principle in action in the home in which I was raised. Having lost her husband, my widowed mother was incomplete. How she prayed for what she needed to fulfill her responsibility to raise her three small children! She was seeking, she was worthy, and she was blessed! Her prayers were answered in many ways, including the receipt of spiritual gifts. She had many, but the ones that stand out in my memory are the gifts of faith, testimony, and wisdom. She was a mighty woman in Zion, a great example of a scripture she loved to quote—Lehi’s promise to his son Jacob that God “shall consecrate thine afflictions for thy gain.” (2 Ne. 2:2.) (“[Spiritual Gifts](#),” *Ensign*, Sept. 1986)

RESURRECTION AND DEGREES OF GLORY

†9. **Elder Bruce R. McConkie:** “By one degree of obedience or another, all men, in this life, develop either celestial, terrestrial, or telestial bodies (or in the case of those destined to be sons of perdition, bodies of a baser sort). In the resurrection all men receive back again ‘the

same body which was a natural body,' whether it be celestial, terrestrial, or what have you. That body is then quickened by the glory attending its particular type, and the person receiving the body then goes automatically, as it were, to the kingdom of glory where that degree of glory is found." (*Doctrinal New Testament Commentary*, 1:196)

†10. **Elder Jeffrey R. Holland:** "Furthermore, although the Resurrection of the body is a free and universal gift from Christ, a result of His victory over death, the nature of the resurrected body (or "degree of glory" given it), as well as the time of one's Resurrection, is affected directly by one's faithfulness in this life. The Apostle Paul made clear, for example, that those fully committed to Christ will "rise first" [10] in the Resurrection. Modern revelation clarifies the different orders of resurrected bodies, [11] promising the highest degree of glory only to those who adhere to the principles and ordinances of the gospel of Jesus Christ. [12] ("[The Atonement of Jesus Christ](#)," *Ensign*, Mar. 2008)

[10] [1 Thessalonians 4:16](#)

[11] See [D&C 76:50-113](#)

[12] See [D&C 76:50-70](#); [88:4, 27-29](#); [132:21-24](#)

Recommended Reading:

1. Daniel Rona, Hidden LDS/Jewish Insights, "[New Testament Gospel Doctrine Supplement #34](#)"; accessed 9/6/15. This handout is about the similarities of Jewish and LDS Marriage Customs, which supplements section 1. of the lesson. See 1 Corinthians 11:1-3, 11-12.

2. Lenet H. Read, New Testament 34: "[Keep the Ordinances as I Delivered Them](#)," accessed 9/8/15.

3. "[Gifts of the Spirit](#)," BYU Studies, accessed 9/8/15.

4. Monte Shelley's Notes, "[NT 34: Charity and the gifts of the Spirit](#)," accessed 9/8/15.

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